BRYLLA ACADEMY
digital skills for virtual work

FREE RESOURCE

CLIENT READINESS CHECKLIST

Are You Actually Ready to Start Getting Freelance Clients?

Before you start sending proposals, applying for opportunities, or reaching out to potential clients, take a few minutes to check whether your freelance foundation is ready.

This checklist will help you identify what is already in place, what needs attention, and what you should work on next.

By **Priscilla Quaidoo**

48 CHECKS · 8 AREAS

Before You Start Chasing Clients

Getting your first client isn't only about having a skill.

You also need to be able to clearly communicate what you offer, show evidence that you can do the work, present yourself professionally, and have a simple process for handling a client once they say yes.

1. **Use this checklist honestly.**
2. Tick an item only if you can confidently say, **"Yes, I have this."**
3. You do not need to have everything perfect before you start. The goal is to identify the gaps that could make getting or serving clients harder.

THE CHECKLIST COVERS EIGHT AREAS

01 Your Offer
02 Your Skills
03 Your Proof
04 Your Online Presence
05 Finding Clients
06 Pricing
07 Your Client Process
08 Your Professional Setup

01 YOUR OFFER ___ / 6

- ☐ I can clearly explain what service I provide.
- ☐ I know who I want to provide it to.
- ☐ I understand the problem my service solves.
- ☐ I have chosen 1–3 core services instead of trying to offer everything.
- ☐ I can explain why a client would pay for my service.
- ☐ I know what makes my service different from others offering something similar.

> **Quick check**
> If someone asked, “What exactly do you do?”, could you answer in one or two clear sentences?

02 YOUR SKILLS ___ / 6

- ☐ I can confidently perform the services I am offering.
- ☐ I have practiced the tools required for my service.
- ☐ I know what I can and cannot do for a client.
- ☐ I have a way to handle tasks I haven’t encountered before.
- ☐ I can complete my core tasks within a realistic timeframe.
- ☐ I am actively improving the skills that need work.

> **Remember**
> You don’t need to know everything. You need to be honest about what you can deliver and willing to learn what is reasonable.

03 YOUR PROOF ___ / 5

- ☐ I have at least one example of my work.
- ☐ My portfolio reflects the service I want to sell.
- ☐ I can explain the outcome or value of my work where possible.
- ☐ I have testimonials, reviews, previous work, or relevant experience I can reference.
- ☐ If I don't have client experience, I have created relevant sample projects.

> **No client experience yet?**
> You can create sample projects that demonstrate how you would solve a realistic client's problem.

04 YOUR ONLINE PRESENCE ___ / 6

- ☐ My LinkedIn profile clearly communicates what I do.
- ☐ My headline is specific rather than simply saying "Freelancer."
- ☐ My About section supports my positioning.
- ☐ My profile photo is professional and recognizable.
- ☐ My contact information or preferred way to reach me is easy to find.
- ☐ My social profiles don't contradict the professional image I'm presenting.

> **Your profile is part of your pitch.**
> A potential client may look you up before deciding whether to respond to you.

05 FINDING CLIENTS ___ / 6

- ☐ I know where my ideal clients spend time online.
- ☐ I have at least one reliable way to find potential clients.
- ☐ I know how to research a prospect before contacting them.
- ☐ I have a basic outreach or proposal process.
- ☐ I know how I will follow up without becoming spammy.
- ☐ I am prepared for rejection and non-responses.

> **Don't rely on one platform.**
> Your client acquisition strategy can include platforms such as LinkedIn, Upwork, cold email, referrals, communities, networking, or direct outreach.

06 PRICING ___ / 6

- ☐ I have a starting rate or package price.
- ☐ I know exactly what is included in my service.
- ☐ I know what is outside the scope of my service.
- ☐ I know how I will handle additional requests.
- ☐ I have decided how clients will pay me.
- ☐ I know my minimum acceptable rate.

> **Know your boundaries before the client asks.**
> Clear pricing and scope make client conversations much easier.

07 YOUR CLIENT PROCESS ___ / 7

- ☐ I have a way for prospects to book a call or contact me.
- ☐ I know what questions I need to ask before accepting a project.
- ☐ I have a basic onboarding process.
- ☐ I know how I will collect the information or access I need.
- ☐ I have a way to track client tasks and deadlines.
- ☐ I know how I will communicate with clients.
- ☐ I have a process for handling feedback and revisions.

08 YOUR PROFESSIONAL SETUP ___ / 6

- ☐ I have a reliable internet connection.
- ☐ I have a suitable device for my work.
- ☐ I have a professional email address.
- ☐ My important files are backed up.
- ☐ I have a workable environment for completing client tasks and attending calls.
- ☐ I have a system for managing passwords and client information securely.

How Client-Ready Are You?

There are 48 checklist items in this guide. Count how many boxes you checked across all eight sections and write your total below.

MY TOTAL _____ / 48

40–48 CHECKED

You're in a strong starting position.

You have many of the foundations needed to start actively looking for clients. Focus on taking consistent action while improving your weaker areas.

30–39 CHECKED

You're getting close.

You have a foundation, but there are a few gaps worth addressing before you rely heavily on client acquisition.

20–29 CHECKED

Build your foundation.

You have some pieces in place, but strengthening your offer, proof, positioning, or client process could make your search much easier.

0–19 CHECKED

Start with the basics.

Focus on your offer, skills, proof, and professional setup before putting most of your energy into finding clients.

> **Your score isn't a judgment. It's a starting point.**
> You do not need to wait until everything is perfect before taking action.

Your Next 3 Actions

After completing the checklist, write down the three areas you need to work on first.

1. **My biggest gap:**

   What I will do about it:

2. **My second priority:**

   What I will do about it:

3. **My third priority:**

   What I will do about it:

READY TO START?

You don't need a perfect profile, perfect portfolio, or perfect business before you start looking for clients.

You need a clear offer, enough skill to deliver, proof that builds trust, and a simple process for moving from prospect to client.

Start where you are. Fix the gaps. Then take action.

Priscilla Quaidoo

Practical resources for building a freelance career.